Discussion: "Hidden Hostility, Donor Attention and Political Violence" by Anderson, Francois, Rohner, Santarrosa

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Overview

- Important research questions
  - Political violence: international attention
  - Understanding of important institutional details: African countries' state capacity and nature of conflicts, compared to Durante and Zhuravskaya (2018) in the middle east
- Model
  - Clear and transparent illustration

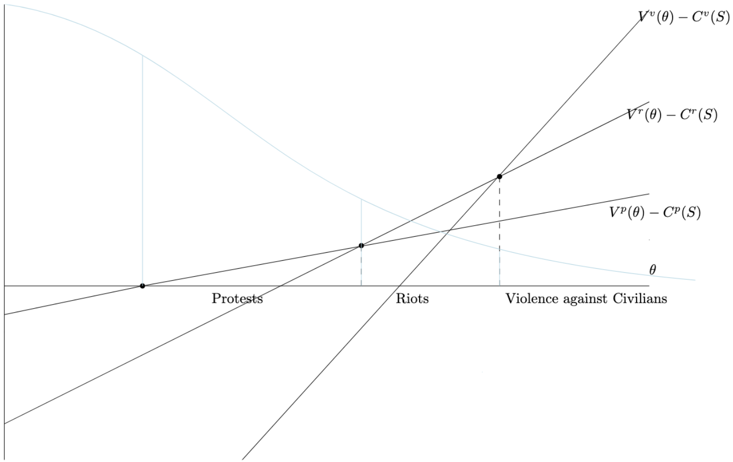
Overview

- Empirical work
  - Careful data construction and analysis
  - Clean Identification
  - Numerous robustness checks and interesting extensions: e.g., democratic vs authoritarian doners, China, ...

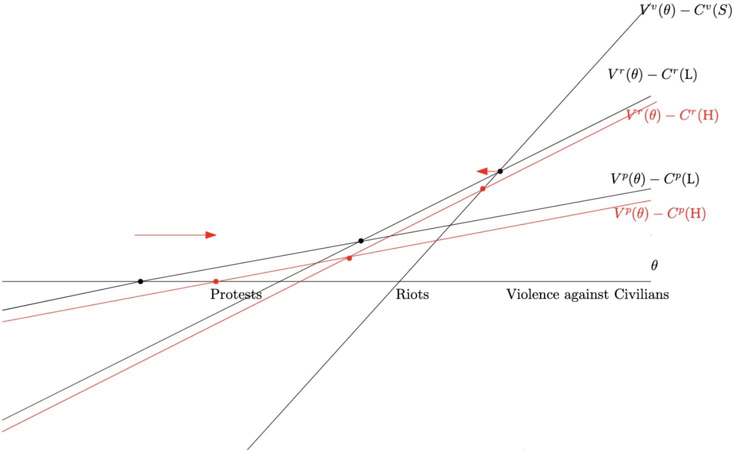
Overview

- Excellent work
  - Enjoy reading and learning from it
- Answer important questions that matter for many people
- Important findings and mechanisms that we may overlook
  - decrease of riots may not necessarily be good
  - response of opposition group
  - based on deep understanding of important institutions
- Careful data construction and analysis

Model: Protests, Riots and Violence

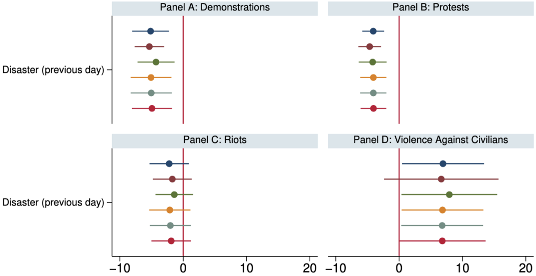


Model: Donner Attention Away, High Repression



Empirical Results: Unanticipated, Conditional

- Shock to government repression: Disaster (unanticipated)
- Ongoing dissent (conditional) $D = 1$
  - government increases repression $S = H$
  - protests or riots $\downarrow$
  - violence against civilians $\uparrow$



Empirical Results: Unanticipated, Unconditional

- Shock unanticipated (disaster)
- If $D = 1$
  - protests or riots $\downarrow$
  - violence against civilians $\uparrow$
- Probability of $D = 1 \downarrow$
  - protests or riots $\downarrow$
  - violence $\downarrow$
- Violence $\updownarrow$?
  - $\triangle V = P(D_1) * \triangle V(D_1) \uparrow + \triangle P(D_1) \downarrow * V(D_1)$

Empirical Results: Anticipated

- Shock anticipated (election)
- In general similar implications to unanticipated shocks (disaster)
- Except: the coefficient on violence is more negative than unanticipated

$$\triangle V = \underbrace{P(D_1)}_{\text{small}} * \triangle V(D_1)\uparrow + \triangle P(D_1)\downarrow * V(D_1)$$

Comments: Direct Evidence

- $P(D = 1)$
  - decrease in the unconditional case
  - is small in the anticipated case

Comments: Results

- Predictions and empirical results presentation
  - Start with the simplest case (closest to the model)?
  - Unanticipated, Conditional (Disaster, D=1)
  - Unanticipated, Unconditional
  - Anticipated, Conditional
  - Anticipated, Unconditional

Comments: Model

- In addition to the baseline scenario (Unanticipated, Conditional $D = 1$)
- Formally derive the implications of other scenarios
  - unconditional: $V = P(D = 1) * V(D = 1)$
  - anticipated: decision of $D = 1$ considering $n(= 2?)$ periods
- Stated as propositions while the details left in the Appendix
- $S = R$ in main text, while $S = L$ in Figure 2

Conclusion

- Look forward to learning more from this project!
- Thank you!